BuzzFest (formerly Apna Bakery) — A Product Journey

From user research to a working beta: how a bakery-ordering idea was researched, designed, built and documented.

Live site: https://buzz-fest.vercel.app/
Code: https://github.com/rnijampure/buzzFest

> **Draft notes (delete before publishing).** Items marked **[ADD YOUR WORDS]** need your own text. Image paths such as `images/01-home.png` are placeholders for screenshots you export. Statuses marked "To confirm" in section 7 need your check against the live site.

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1. At a Glance

Product	BuzzFest, an online ordering marketplace for home-baked goods. Its working name during the design phase was "Apna Bakery".
My role	UX researcher, visual designer and developer. I also wrote the product and technical documentation.
Research and design	November to December 2023
Build	**[ADD YOUR WORDS: build dates]**
Status	Beta proof of concept (a sample project)
Tools	Google Slides and Figma for research and design; Next.js, React, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, Prisma, PostgreSQL (Neon), Zustand, Cloudinary and Vercel for the build

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2. The Problem and the Goal

The product. An online app for ordering from "Apna Bakery", a store in Koramangala, Bangalore. The store caters mostly for an affluent young population but also needs to care for its non-affluent customers, who make up 30% of its customer base.

The problem. The bakery wants to increase its customer base and make it easier to place orders, find products and thereby increase business.

Goal statement.

> Our Bakery App will let users purchase their desired/required product, which will affect users who don't have time, want to save money or may have disabilities, by allowing them to order fast, cheaper and in a user friendly (accessible) way.

How success would be measured. By an increase in the number of orders received.

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3. Research: Understanding the Users

I ran user research with a group of 10 clients. Three became model personas, chosen so that all age groups, gender identities and socio-economic statuses were covered.

The research found four pain points:

#	Pain point	What users said
1	**Healthier alternatives**	Users are looking for healthier options, though they still like to eat sweets.
2	**Offers and prices**	Low/middle income groups want use of coupons or offers to make exotic items accessible to them.
3	**Updates on delivery**	Customers want better options for bulk ordering and updates on delivery.
4	**Accessibility**	Elderly folks and those who are not familiar with technology find it difficult to order online.

4. Define: Personas and Journey Map

Three personas

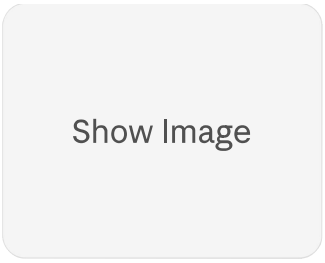
Persona	Who	What she or he needs
Ritika Krishnamurthy, 29, software engineer	A working mother of two who orders often and throws parties.	A fast app, suggestions based on past orders, delivery updates, combos for bulk orders and discounts on frequent buys.
Ramvilas Shukla, 47, lecturer	A budget-conscious father who orders occasionally.	More discounts and an easy way to find cheaper options.
Halima Sadiya, 65, homemaker	Recently started using a mobile phone; has been advised to eat sugar-free options.	An intuitive, less text-based app, a sugar-free filter, and a way to call the bakery directly.

Journey map: Ritika orders for a party tonight

The journey map follows Ritika from searching for a bakery to waiting for delivery. It shows where the experience fails her today:

- Phone ordering is slow, and long explanations from the executive irritate her.
- She worries the address and items were taken down correctly.
- She has to call repeatedly for delivery status and gets the same answer each time.

The opportunities it identified were fewer ordering steps, a quick list of previous orders, order details with a customer-care number sent by email, and real-time delivery updates.



5. Design: From Wireframes to a Style Guide

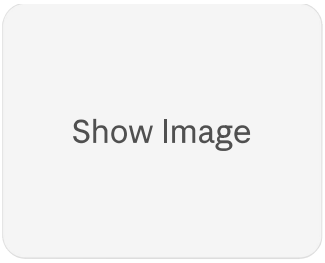
The design phase moved through a user flow, paper and digital wireframes, a low-fidelity prototype, usability studies, mockups and a high-fidelity prototype.

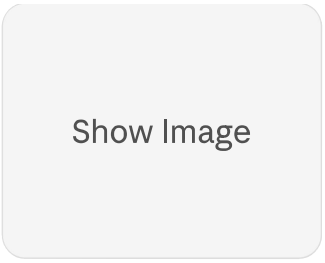
User flow

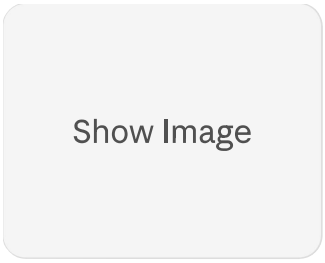
Open app → Home page → Search cakes → Select an item → Product detail page → Confirm/Add → Cart page → Address page → Payment method page → Order confirmation page.

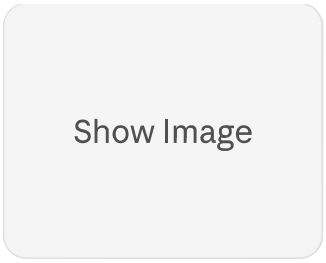
Screens designed

Screen	Design decision
Home	Top offers listed first. A language selector (Hindi) and three text-size controls (A A A) at the top of the page. Category links such as Christmas Collection, Theme Cakes and Chocolates.
Search	A search bar with category chips (Cakes, Chocolates, Cookies), and results in a tabbed layout (Cakes, Cookies, Biscuits, Chocolates). Results for "sugar free" show the MRP crossed out next to the offer price.
Product detail	Quantity, a "Check delivery" field that takes a PIN code, a minimum preparation time (6 hours), a description, Add to Cart, and a "Frequently bought together" section.
Cart	Choose a pack and quantity for each item, then choose Store Pickup (free) or Home Delivery. Price details are shown before checkout.
Checkout	Three steps: Address, Shipping, Payment.
Confirmation	"Order Confirmed" and a note that order details were emailed.
Phone and accessibility	A phone icon in the header and in the bottom bar for "order by phone", for users who are not comfortable with the app.









Accessibility considerations

- Colour contrast is kept strong across the app.
- Text can be resized or zoomed.
- Icons are medium-sized and easy to understand.

Style guide (UI library)

The Apna Bakery UI Library is a style guide meant to help developers and designers follow the brand styles.

Colour. Keeping in mind the chocolate-cake specialty, the whole site uses a chocolate-coloured theme and only these colours, including hover states, selected states, text and icons.

Name	Hex	Name	Hex
DarkBrown	#75372A	LightGreen	#7FB56D
MidBrown	#893813	BorderGrey	#7F7979
LightBrown	#B15C36	Black	#000000
LightOrange	#FDB343	Disabled TextGrey	#979797
DisabledGrey	#C4C4C4	White	#FFFFFF

Typography. The brand font family is Inter.

Style	Weight	Size
Header 1	Semi-bold	36
Header 2 (capitals)	Bold	22
Header 3 (title case)	Semi-bold	20
Large button text (upper case)	Semi-bold	30
Small button text	Regular	20
Breadcrumbs, small body and input text	Regular	16
Small body text	Regular	14
Checkout step labels (selected: bold)	Regular	17

Buttons and form elements. There are two types of buttons: smaller ones for minor actions and larger ones for primary navigation. On mobile the button width is 100%, and on desktop it has a maximum width of 400px. Primary buttons have a border radius of 3. The guide defines enabled and disabled inputs, a drop-down, a checkbox and a toggle.

Components. Reusable components include a tabbed layout and selected and unselected options, such as a delivery option.

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6. Build: What Shipped in the Beta

BuzzFest is built as a working beta. The product documentation covers the details; in short, customers can:

- Browse four Bangalore-based bakers and their products, with prices in ₹, star ratings, stock counts, a vegetarian indicator and category tags.
- Add products to a cart and place an order as a guest, with per-item instructions and messages.

Each order is saved with a status (Pending, Paid, Preparing, Out for delivery, Completed or Cancelled) and with the price paid at the time of purchase.

Technology. Next.js and React with TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, Zustand for cart state, Prisma with a PostgreSQL database on Neon, Cloudinary for images, and Vercel for hosting.

Data model. Six tables: Baker, Product, ProductVariant, Order, OrderItem and Task.

Show Image

7. Research to Product: What Carried Over

The design phase covered more than the beta builds. This table compares each research finding with what the live beta does today.

Research finding	Designed in Apna Bakery	In the BuzzFest beta
Healthier alternatives	Search for "sugar free" and category filters.	**Partly.** A "Guilt Free Indulgence" section on the home page, a vegetarian indicator, and diet tags such as vegan, eggless and sugar-free. A sugar-free filter: *to confirm*.
Offers and prices	MRP shown crossed out beside the offer price; top offers on the home page.	**Not built.** The data model has a single price and no discount or MRP field.
Updates on delivery	"Check delivery" by PIN; a confirmation email; real-time updates in the journey map.	**Data model only.** Orders can have an "Out for delivery" status; customer-facing tracking: *to confirm*.
Bulk ordering	Choose a pack; "Frequently bought together".	**Partly.** Quantity per item, variants in the data model and per-item instructions. Pack options and combos: *to confirm*.
Accessibility	Hindi language option, text-size controls and an order-by-phone icon.	*To confirm.*
Quick reordering	Suggestions based on last ordered items (Ritika).	*To confirm.*

8. How the Idea Evolved

Apna Bakery began as an ordering app for a single store in Koramangala. BuzzFest became a marketplace of several home bakers.

[ADD YOUR WORDS: how and why the idea moved from one store to many home bakers, and what you kept from the research. Two or three sentences are enough.]

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9. Learnings and Next Steps

Impact. Learnings drawn from the usability study, changed our path from being focused on "appealing designs" to more user centric accessible design.

What I learned. User perspective is key for business success, weather its digital product, or anything else.

Next steps for BuzzFest:

- Build the operations application for managing orders.
- Add baker onboarding (the "Join Us" link is currently a placeholder).
- Check stock at checkout (the beta does not enforce stock).
- Add offers and delivery updates, the two research findings not yet in the beta.

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10. Documentation

I documented the project at two levels:

- **Product documentation:** what BuzzFest is, who it is for, what works today and what does not, written for a mixed audience. Every claim was checked against the live site, the database schema and sample data, and the document lists its known limitations.
- **Technical documentation for developers:** *in progress.*

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11. Materials and Links

Material	Link
Live site	https://buzz-fest.vercel.app/
Code repository	https://github.com/rnijampure/buzzFest
Case study deck (29 slides)	https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1LEFaP4QtHL6kJTGzFGF35TZScXkSBKyGo-bjZ685E84/edit?usp=drive_link
User personas	https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1rBo8M4iJ_fYfESuEOA8GO0LVJFTZpKO7-T0fUs0YJHM/edit?slide=id.p1#slide=id.p1
Goal statement	https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1SZcn-R_lnbeEy_HqDs7kGKTQoZKDUv04anHT9yommk0/edit?usp=sharing
User journey map	https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1pS0mijFzZy4Gc-8qvBmDFODq-DrDIDtF3VrQLXujrwE/edit?usp=sharing
Style guide (Figma)	https://www.figma.com/design/jXPhHzYfmfR2anT7Wylw0r/APNAbAKERY-team-library
Wireframes and prototypes (Figma)	https://www.figma.com/file/YOcjM3VQQ0ydyezJGQjphi/APNA-BAKERY-HOME-SCREEN
Product documentation	buzzfest-product-documentation.md